BLAINE COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE

K-9 DIVISION STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Structure, responsibilities & operational standards

COMMAND REVIEW DRAFT
Prepared October 23, 2026

Editorial refresh of the supplied K-9 SOP: consistent titles, numbered subsections, clearer role descriptions, and linked navigation. Sections are organized to place division leadership after the mission statement and K-9 controls after roleplay standards.

Approval status: This revision is prepared for command review. Approval of this refreshed edition has not been recorded. The existing SOP assigns SOP approval authority to Division Oversight.

Using this document
Select a title or subsection in the contents to jump directly to it. PDF bookmarks provide the same navigation. Each body page includes a return-to-contents link.

Appendix A records editorial changes and the policy clarifications incorporated into this draft. It is a revision reference, not an additional operational policy.

Contents

Select any numbered entry to navigate to that section.

1. Mission Statement 4
- 1.1 Mission . . . 4
- 1.2 Division Functions . . . 4
- 1.3 Professional Standard . . . 4

2. K-9 Rank Structure & Responsibilities 5
- 2.1 Division Oversight Supervisor . . . 5
- 2.2 K-9 Commander & Co-Commander . . . 5
- 2.3 K-9 Field Training Officers . . . 5
- 2.4 Senior K-9 Handler . . . 5
- 2.5 K-9 Handler . . . 5
- 2.6 K-9 Trainee . . . 5

3. Jurisdiction & Deployment Authority 6
- 3.1 Service Area & Requests . . . 6
- 3.2 Handler Discretion . . . 6

4. Recruitment & Eligibility Requirements 6
- 4.1 Eligibility . . . 6
- 4.2 Selection Process . . . 6

5. Training & Certifications 7
- 5.1 Initial Certification . . . 7
- 5.2 Continuing Requirements & Extra Field Training . . . 7
- 5.3 SWAT K-9 Cross-Certification . . . 7
- 5.3.1 Approved SWAT K-9 Uniforms . . . 8
- 5.4 EOD K-9 Cross-Certification . . . 9
- 5.5 CIU/STIU K-9 Cross-Certification . . . 9

6. Uniform & Equipment Standards 10
- 6.1 Handler Uniform & Equipment . . . 10
- 6.2 Canine Vest . . . 10
- 6.3 Approved K-9 Handler Uniforms . . . 11

7. Vehicle Policy 12
- 7.1 Approved Vehicles & Equipment . . . 12
- 7.2 Unioning . . . 12
- 7.3 Speed & Vehicle Conditions . . . 12
- 7.4 Prisoner Transport . . . 12

8. Authorized K-9 Uses 13
- 8.1 Narcotics Detection . . . 13
- 8.2 Criminal Apprehension . . . 13
- 8.3 Tracking . . . 13
- 8.4 Article & Evidence Searches . . . 13
- 8.5 Appropriate Deployment Situations . . . 13

9. Use of Force Guidelines 14

Return to contents

9.1 Force Classification & Warnings . . . 14
9.2 Pre-Deployment Conditions . . . 14
9.3 Situations to Avoid Deployment . . . 14
9.4 After the Suspect Is Secured . . . 14
10. Roleplay Standards **14**
10.1 Who May Roleplay as a K-9 . . . 14
10.2 Required Methods & Realism . . . 14
11. K-9 Controls & Deployment Menu **15**
11.1 Access & Available Actions . . . 15
11.2 Bite Control & Menu Notes . . . 15
12. Call Response Protocol **15**
12.1 Permitted Patrol Activities . . . 15
12.2 Response & Deployment Restrictions . . . 15
13. Responsibilities During Deployment **16**
13.1 Handler Responsibilities . . . 16
14. Reporting Requirements **16**
14.1 Events Requiring a Report . . . 16
14.2 Required Report Information . . . 16
14.3 Failure to Report . . . 16
14.4 K-9 Use-of-Force Review . . . 16
15. Disciplinary Action **17**
15.1 Accountability & Available Actions . . . 17
15.2 Warning & Three-Strike Progression . . . 17
16. Removal & Reinstatement **17**
16.1 Reapplication After Disciplinary Removal . . . 17
17. Community Conduct **17**
17.1 Public Representation . . . 17
18. Amendments **17**
18.1 Amendment & Approval Authority . . . 17
18.2 Historical Credits . . . 17
A. Revision Record **18**
A.1 Completed Refresh . . . 18
A.2 Policy Clarifications Incorporated . . . 18
A.3 Release Status . . . 18

Return to contents

1. Mission Statement

1.1 Mission

The mission of the Blaine County Sheriff's Office (BCSO) K-9 Division is to enhance public safety and support law enforcement operations throughout Blaine County and the State of San Andreas through the professional, ethical, and effective deployment of trained police canines.

1.2 Division Functions

- Assist in crime prevention and detection.
- Support criminal apprehension and enhance deputy safety.
- Assist in narcotics detection and missing persons searches.
- Conduct article and evidence searches.
- Provide community engagement and public demonstrations.

1.3 Professional Standard

All handlers will conduct operations with realism, professionalism, and respect for roleplay standards at all times.

Return to contents

2. K-9 Rank Structure & Responsibilities

2.1 Division Oversight Supervisor

Listed officeholder: Chief Deputy Norf.

- Oversees the entire division.
- Approves SOP changes.
- Holds final authority on disciplinary matters.

2.2 K-9 Commander & Co-Commander

Commander: Master Sergeant Jacob.
Co-Commander: Master Corporal D. Edwards.

The Commander and Co-Commander share the following responsibilities:

- Manage daily division operations.
- Oversee training schedules.
- Report directly to Division Oversight.
- Review K-9 use-of-force report narratives to determine whether the force was justified.

2.3 K-9 Field Training Officers

The K-9 FTO structure, in descending order, is Head K-9 FTO, Lead K-9 FTO, Assistant K-9 FTO, and K-9 FTO.

- **Head K-9 FTO:** Leads trainings and may review K-9 use-of-force report narratives to determine whether the force was justified. This is a supervisory role.
- **Lead K-9 FTO:** Leads trainings. This is a non-supervisory role.
- **Assistant K-9 FTO:** Assists with trainings. This is a non-supervisory role.
- **K-9 FTO:** Assists with trainings. This is a non-supervisory role.

All K-9 FTOs mentor trainees and must attend at least one training event per month.

2.4 Senior K-9 Handler

- Mentors trainees.
- May review K-9 use-of-force report narratives to determine whether the force was justified.

2.5 K-9 Handler

- Is fully certified.
- Performs patrol duties.
- Deploys the K-9 when justified.

2.6 K-9 Trainee

- Remains under training status.
- May not deploy solo.
- Must complete training.

Return to contents

3. Jurisdiction & Deployment Authority

3.1 Service Area & Requests

The K-9 Division operates primarily within Blaine County. Any law enforcement agency within San Andreas may request a K-9 unit. K-9 units may respond to K-9 requests without supervisor approval.

Requests should be made by radio and include:

- Nature of the request.
- Location.
- Suspect status, if applicable.
- Whether weapons are involved.

3.2 Handler Discretion

The handler maintains discretion to accept or decline a request based on safety and to withdraw a K-9 when deployment becomes unsafe or unjustified. See Section 12 for call response restrictions.

4. Recruitment & Eligibility Requirements

4.1 Eligibility

To apply, a deputy must:

- Hold the rank of Deputy II or higher.
- Demonstrate strong radio etiquette.
- Have no active disciplinary strike.
- Show consistent, high-quality roleplay.
- Receive approval from K-9 Leadership.

4.2 Selection Process

The selection process consists of meeting the Deputy II prerequisite, attending a mass training, and acceptance as a K-9 Handler. Acceptance is not guaranteed. Training and certification requirements are listed in Section 5.

Return to contents

5. Training & Certifications

5.1 Initial Certification

All K-9 members must complete:

- Initial Handler Certification Course.
- Scenario-based deployment testing.
- Command proficiency evaluation.
- Roleplay realism assessment.

5.2 Continuing Requirements & Extra Field Training

- Attend mandatory training sessions.
- Maintain consistent activity and generate at least three K-9 reports per month.
- A month of inconsistent activity may result in removal from the division.

Extra Field Training (EFT) may be assigned by K-9 Command or requested. Failure to attend required training may result in suspension from the unit.

5.3 SWAT K-9 Cross-Certification

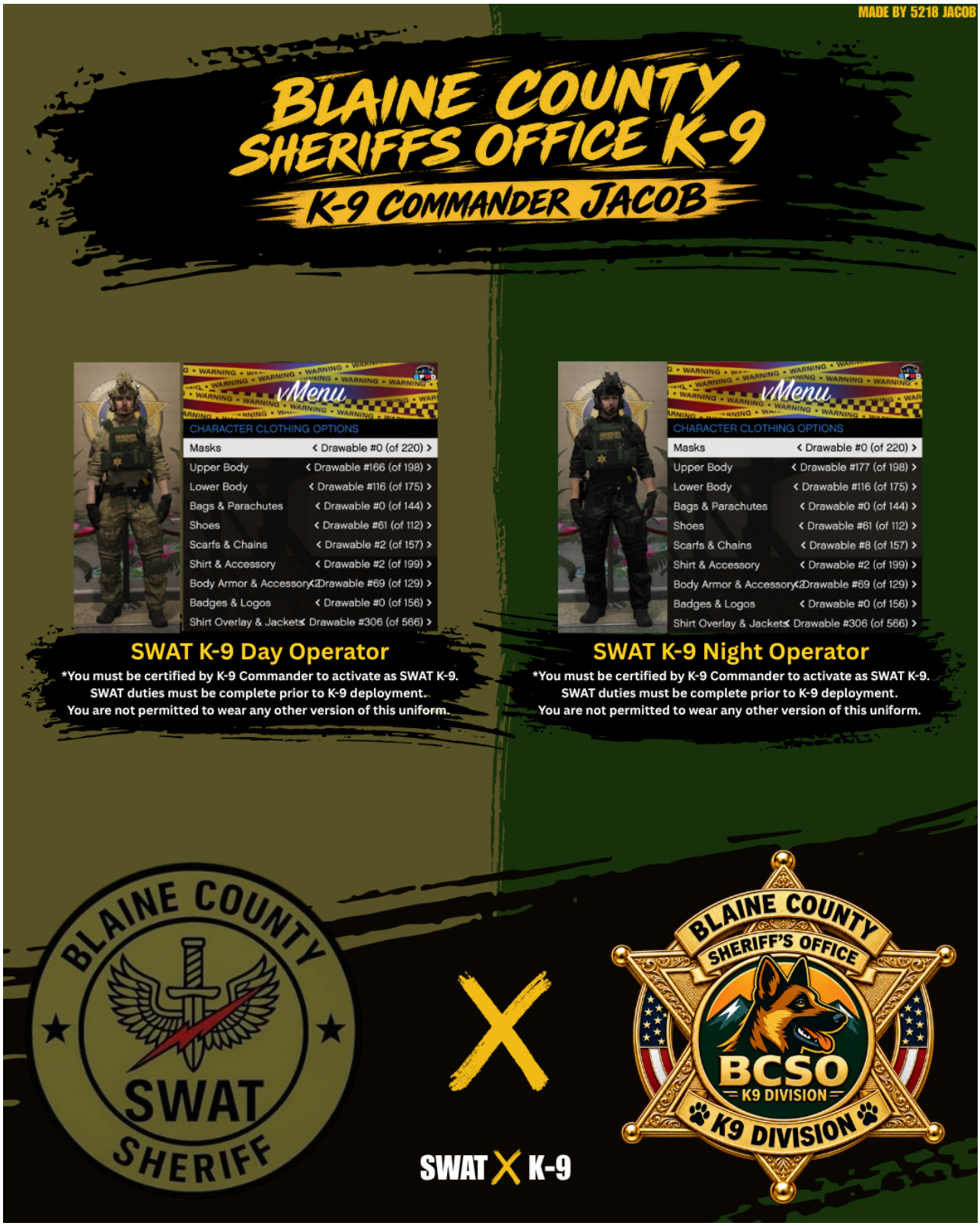
To activate as SWAT K-9, a member must be rostered in both SWAT and K-9, complete advanced training and certification training, and be certified by the K-9 Commander. Members must complete and pass advanced training to qualify for cross-certifications. SWAT duties must be completed before K-9 deployment.

A SWAT-certified K-9 may assist with:

- Building and room clearing.
- Locating hidden suspects before entry.
- Tracking fleeing suspects.
- Apprehending violent suspects.
- Narcotics detection.

Return to contents

5.3.1 Approved SWAT K-9 Uniforms



Return to contents

5.4 EOD K-9 Cross-Certification

To activate as EOD K-9, a member must be EOD-certified in SWAT and have completed advanced K-9 training and K-9 certification training. An EOD-certified K-9 may assist with explosives detection.

5.5 CIU/STIU K-9 Cross-Certification

The same eligibility, training, activation, and operational rules apply to CIU K-9 and STIU K-9. To activate in either assignment, a member must be rostered in K-9 and the applicable subdivision (CIU or STIU), complete advanced training and certification training, and be certified by the K-9 Commander. CIU/STIU K-9 must be specially requested.

CIU/STIU K-9 may assist with:

- Narcotics detection during search warrants.
- Searching vehicles, residences, or stash houses.
- Evidence recovery, including firearms, casings, and clothing.
- Apprehension if suspects flee during investigations.

Return to contents

6. Uniform & Equipment Standards

6.1 Handler Uniform & Equipment

All K-9 personnel shall:

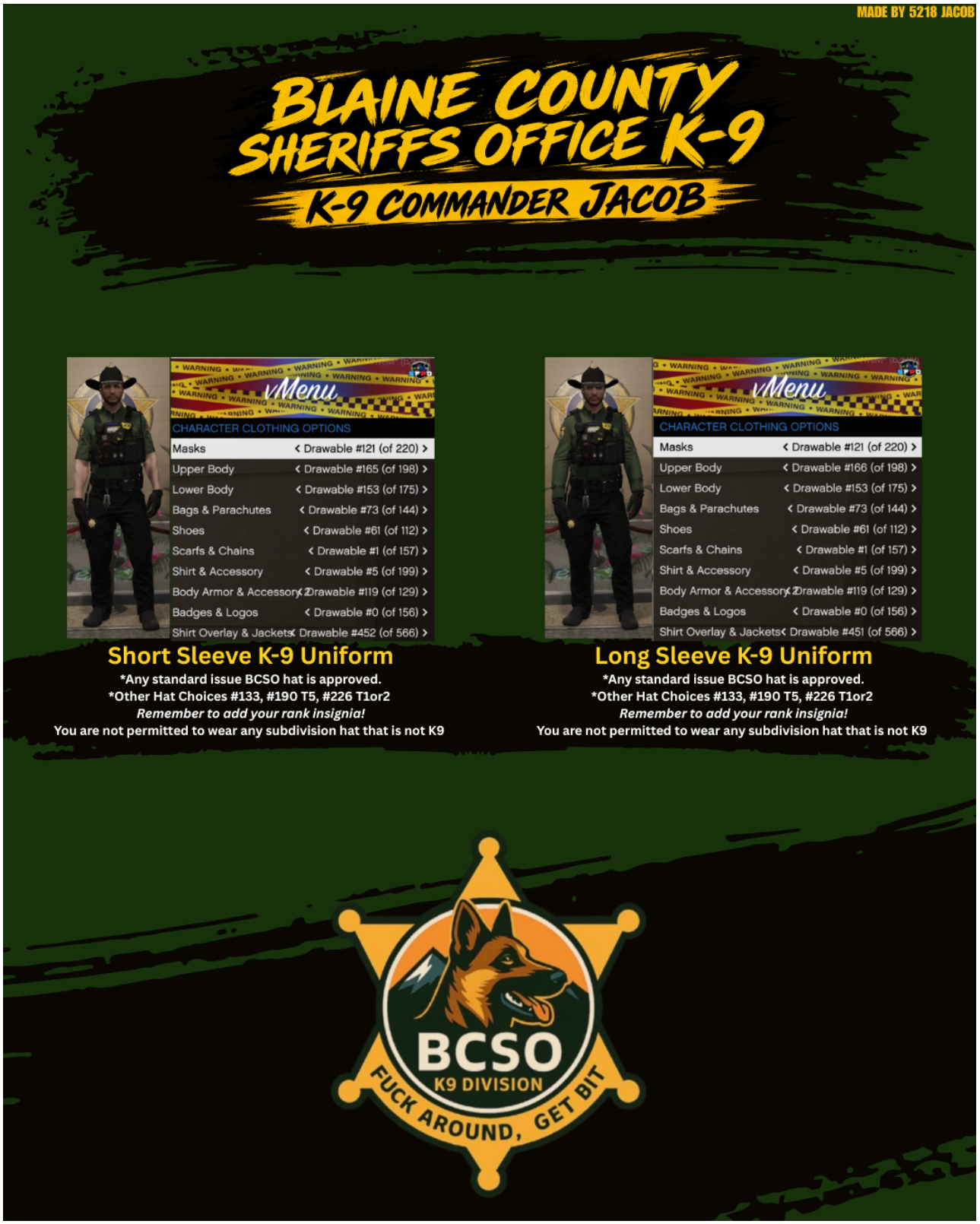
- Wear the approved K-9 uniforms shown in this SOP. Do not use the uniforms listed on the BCSO HQ website, as they are outdated. Refer to Section 6.3 for K-9 Handler uniforms and Section 5.3.1 for SWAT K-9 uniforms.
- Carry appropriate duty belt equipment.
- Equip an approved long gun if policy permits.
- Use only approved K-9 patrol vehicles.

6.2 Canine Vest

The K-9 may be equipped with a black or green Sheriff's vest.

Return to contents

6.3 Approved K-9 Handler Uniforms



Return to contents

7. Vehicle Policy

7.1 Approved Vehicles & Equipment

- Only approved K-9 vehicles may transport a police canine.
- /VS K-9 vehicle equipment must align with the vehicle equipment policy in the BCSO SOP.
- K-9 vehicles must remain clean and professional in appearance.

7.2 Unioning

- K-9 Handlers may union with Senior K-9 Handlers only while on duty as K-9.
- Head and Lead K-9 FTOs may union with any K-9 Handler to review skill gaps and abilities.

7.3 Speed & Vehicle Conditions

- K-9 vehicles may never exceed 130 MPH.
- K-9 vehicles must have their engine running and/or the rear window down.

7.4 Prisoner Transport

Prisoner transport is strictly prohibited in K-9 vehicles unless the vehicle is equipped with a half cage. If an arrest is made, call for patrol transport or County Prisoner Transport.

Return to contents

8. Authorized K-9 Uses

8.1 Narcotics Detection

- Traffic stops with probable cause.
- Search warrants.
- Suspicious vehicle searches.

8.2 Criminal Apprehension

- Fleeing suspects, after verbal warnings.
- Armed suspects in concealment.
- Felony evasion.

8.3 Tracking

- Foot pursuits.
- Missing persons.
- Escaped suspects.

8.4 Article & Evidence Searches

- Discarded weapons.
- Evidence recovery.

Authorized uses must be read together with the force restrictions in Section 9 and the call response provisions in Section 12. Cross-certified assignments are addressed in Section 5.

8.5 Appropriate Deployment Situations

- Fleeing suspects.
- Violent felonies.
- Officer safety risks.
- Search operations.
- High-risk apprehensions.

Return to contents

9. Use of Force Guidelines

9.1 Force Classification & Warnings

A K-9 is considered a less-lethal but significant use of force. Handlers must issue at least three clear verbal warnings before a bite deployment. The three-warning requirement applies only to bite deployments, not to sniffs, tracking, or other non-bite deployments.

Warning: "Sheriff's Office K-9! Stop or you will be bit!"

9.2 Pre-Deployment Conditions

Handlers must ensure the suspect has an opportunity to comply, the scene is safe, and backup is present when possible.

9.3 Situations to Avoid Deployment

Avoid K-9 deployment in the following situations:

- Compliant suspects.
- Minor non-violent offenses.
- Crowded public areas.
- Situations where force is not justified.

Crowd control and retaliatory use remain unauthorized.

9.4 After the Suspect Is Secured

Immediately call off the K-9, render roleplay medical aid, and transition to custody.

10. Roleplay Standards

10.1 Who May Roleplay as a K-9

Non-certified deputies or supervisors may not roleplay as a K-9. Non-BCSO members may not roleplay as a K-9.

10.2 Required Methods & Realism

K-9 roleplay must use visual roleplay, /ad or /me commands when close by, and the K-9 menu when applicable. Required elements include:

- Clear deployment commands.
- Realistic bite duration.
- Proper acknowledgment of suspect injuries.
- Veterinary or medical roleplay when applicable.

Powergaming, unrealistic bite durations, and forced outcomes are prohibited.

Return to contents

11. K-9 Controls & Deployment Menu

11.1 Access & Available Actions

Default menu key: **DEL**. Command: **/k9menu**. The keybind may be changed in FiveM Settings > Keybinds.

- Spawn / Despawn.
- Follow / Sit / Stand / Bark.
- Enter / Exit Vehicle.
- Control Dog / Stop Control.
- Appearance Config.

11.2 Bite Control & Menu Notes

Use the **E key while aiming** to trigger a bite. All deployment and force requirements in this SOP still apply.

The source SOP notes that despawning restores the spawn option and that K-9 behavior handling was improved to reduce unintended reactions. These are script behavior notes.

12. Call Response Protocol

12.1 Permitted Patrol Activities

K-9 Handlers may respond to standard patrol calls, self-attach to any traffic stop within their district, and proactively patrol high-crime areas.

12.2 Response & Deployment Restrictions

Handlers shall not:

- Abandon high-risk K-9 calls.
- Deploy without communicating by radio.
- Override on-scene command authority.
- Deploy during an active shooter situation.

Return to contents

13. Responsibilities During Deployment

13.1 Handler Responsibilities

K-9 Handlers should ensure:

- Proper warnings were given.
- The force level was appropriate.
- Roleplay quality was maintained.
- Documentation is completed.
- Backup was requested upon K-9 deployment.

14. Reporting Requirements

14.1 Events Requiring a Report

An incident report must be completed every time the K-9 is deployed from the K-9 vehicle at an incident scene. This requirement applies even if no K-9 assistance is ultimately needed or the incident is declared Code 4 immediately after deployment.

Reportable deployments include bites, tracking, sniffs with or without an alert, searches, use-of-force incidents, and deployments that end without further K-9 activity.

14.2 Required Report Information

Reports must include:

- Time and location, including the road and postal.
- Direction of travel, if applicable.
- Reason for deployment and type of activity, including a sniff, bite, track, search, or deployment that ended without further K-9 activity.
- Warnings given; at least three verbal warnings are required for bite deployments only.
- Suspect behavior.
- Where the K-9 bit and any injuries sustained.
- Any and all medical assistance provided.
- Items found during the search.
- Overall outcome.

14.3 Failure to Report

Failure to report may result in disciplinary action.

14.4 K-9 Use-of-Force Review

The handler shall submit the narrative from their K-9 use-of-force report to the K-9 Commander or Co-Commander for review to determine whether the force was justified. The Head K-9 FTO is also authorized to conduct this review. The existing Senior K-9 Handler review authority is listed in Section 2.4.

The term "clear K-9 discharges" refers to reviewing the K-9 use-of-force report narrative and determining whether the force used was justified.

Return to contents

15. Disciplinary Action

15.1 Accountability & Available Actions

K-9 Handlers are held to a higher roleplay standard. Violations may result in a verbal warning, strike issuance, temporary suspension, removal from the K-9 Division, or department termination.

15.2 Warning & Three-Strike Progression

The source SOP lists the following progression:

- **Initial verbal warning.**
- **Initial written warning.**
- **First strike:** Formal warning.
- **Second strike:** Probation.
- **Third strike:** Removal from the K-9 Division.

Severe violations may bypass the strike progression. Division Oversight holds final authority on disciplinary matters under Section 2.1.

16. Removal & Reinstatement

16.1 Reapplication After Disciplinary Removal

Members removed from the K-9 Division through disciplinary action must wait 30 days before reapplying and must complete certification again. Reinstatement is not guaranteed.

17. Community Conduct

17.1 Public Representation

K-9 members represent the Sheriff's Office at a higher visibility level. Handlers must maintain professionalism, avoid toxic behavior, promote positive roleplay, and assist newer deputies.

18. Amendments

18.1 Amendment & Approval Authority

This SOP may be amended by BCSO Administration and BCSO K-9 Oversight and Command. Section 2.1 assigns approval of SOP changes to the Division Oversight Supervisor.

18.2 Historical Credits

Original author: 5108 Chief Deputy G. Jaeger, former K-9 Co-Commander.
Prior rewrite: 5109 Chief Deputy Norf, former K-9 Commander, and 5110 Chief Deputy Jordan Smith, former K-9 Co-Commander.
Prior rewrite: 5218 Master Sergeant Jacob, K-9 Commander, and former 5281 Master Corporal Desire Azure, former K-9 Co-Commander.

Return to contents

A. Revision Record

Revised by: 5206 | Co-Commander Edwards
Revision date: October 23, 2026

I refreshed this SOP to improve its organization, clarify division responsibilities, and establish consistent deployment and reporting guidance. The revisions are documented below.

A.1 Completed Refresh

- Moved division leadership directly after the mission statement and K-9 controls after roleplay standards. Renumbered sections and updated all cross-references and navigation.
- Added numbered subsections, a linked contents list, PDF bookmarks, and return-to-contents links.
- Standardized headings, spacing, terminology, capitalization, and punctuation.
- Separated each FTO role's stated duties and supervisory status. Retained shared Commander and Co-Commander responsibilities.
- Aligned force and reporting provisions with the clarified bite-only warning requirement.
- Retained named leadership and historical credits from the supplied SOP.

A.2 Policy Clarifications Incorporated

- **Sections 2 and 14.4 - Use-of-force review:** Defined clearing a K-9 discharge as reviewing the handler's K-9 use-of-force narrative to determine whether the force was justified. Specified submission to the Commander or Co-Commander and the Head K-9 FTO's review authority. Existing Senior K-9 Handler review authority remains in Section 2.4.
- **Section 5.5 - CIU/STIU:** Applied the same eligibility, training, activation, and operational rules to both subdivisions.
- **Sections 8.5 and 9.3 - Deployment guidance:** Added the specified appropriate situations and situations to avoid deployment. Retained the prohibitions on crowd control and retaliatory use.
- **Sections 9.1 and 14.2 - Warnings:** Limited the three-verbal-warning requirement to bite deployments.
- **Section 12.2 - Mandatory restrictions:** Changed the response restrictions to "shall not."
- **Section 14.1 - Reporting:** Required an incident report every time the K-9 is deployed from the vehicle at an incident scene, including negative sniffs, deployments where no assistance is needed, and incidents declared Code 4 immediately after deployment.
- **Sections 5.3.1 and 6 - Uniform references:** Added the approved SWAT K-9 and K-9 Handler uniform images. Directed personnel to use the uniforms in this SOP instead of the outdated BCSO HQ website uniforms.

A.3 Release Status

Prepared for command review by 5206 | Co-Commander Edwards. Approval and an effective date remain pending.

Return to contents